

Transition Metals

The largest collection of elements in the periodic table, there are 38 transition metals. Most of them have high melting and boiling points, conduct heat and electricity well, and are easy to shape. These metals are not as reactive as the alkali metals and alkaline earth metals.

Hard metals

The transition metals tend to be dense and hard compared to metals in other sections of the periodic table.

They are frequently mixed together to make alloys, such as steel or brass, which are harder and stronger still.



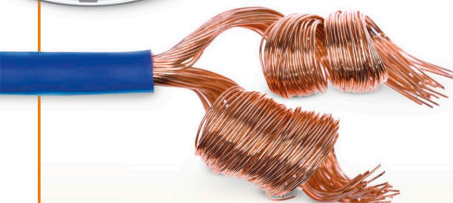
Strong titanium alloy wheel



Bracelet made of gold

Precious metals

The four “precious” metals – gold, silver, platinum, and palladium – are transition metals. They are called precious because they are rare. They stay shiny without corroding, which makes them ideal for crafting jewellery.



Copper wires inside electrical cable

Good conductors

The elements in this group are good conductors, which means that heat and electric currents move through these substances easily. Silver is the best conductor of all, but it is too expensive to use in large amounts. Electrical and telephone wires and television cables are largely made from copper, which is very common.